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Culture of peace

Resolution adopted by the General Assembly on 14 June 2023

[without reference to a Main Committee ([A/77/L.74](#))]

77/296. Follow-up to the Declaration and Programme of Action on a Culture of Peace

The General Assembly,

Bearing in mind the Charter of the United Nations, including the purposes and principles contained therein, and especially the dedication to saving succeeding generations from the scourge of war,

Recalling the Constitution of the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization, which states that, “since wars begin in the minds of men, it is in the minds of men that the defences of peace must be constructed”,

Recognizing the importance of the Declaration and Programme of Action on a Culture of Peace, adopted by the General Assembly on 13 September 1999,¹ which serve as the universal mandate for the international community, particularly the United Nations system, for the promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence that benefits humanity, in particular future generations,

Recalling its previous resolutions on a culture of peace, in particular resolution [52/15](#) of 20 November 1997 proclaiming 2000 the International Year for the Culture of Peace, resolution [53/25](#) of 10 November 1998 proclaiming the period 2001–2010 the International Decade for a Culture of Peace and Non-Violence for the Children of the World, its resolutions on the implementation of and follow-up to the Declaration and Programme of Action on a Culture of Peace, resolution [73/329](#) of 25 July 2019 on promoting the Culture of Peace with Love and Conscience and resolution [75/309](#) of 21 July 2021 on promoting interreligious and intercultural dialogue and tolerance in countering hate speech adopted under its agenda item entitled “Culture of peace”,

Recalling also the adoption of its resolutions [76/68](#) of 9 December 2021 on follow-up to the Declaration and Programme of Action on a Culture of Peace, [76/250](#)

¹ Resolutions [53/243](#) A and B.



of 20 January 2022 on Holocaust denial, [76/254](#) of 15 March 2022 proclaiming 15 March the International Day to Combat Islamophobia, [77/243](#) of 20 December 2022 declaring 12 February the International Day for the Prevention of Violent Extremism as and when Conducive to Terrorism and [77/32](#) of 6 December 2022 declaring 2023 the International Year of Dialogue as a Guarantee of Peace,

Recalling further the United Nations Millennium Declaration² and the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development,³ which call for the active promotion of a culture of peace,

Recalling its resolutions [75/201](#) of 21 December 2020 and [70/262](#) of 27 April 2016 on the review of the United Nations peacebuilding architecture, [72/276](#) of 26 April 2018 on the follow-up to the report of the Secretary-General on peacebuilding and sustaining peace and [76/305](#) of 8 September 2022 on financing for peacebuilding,

Recalling also its resolutions declaring zones of peace in Central Asia,⁴ the South Atlantic⁵ and the Indian Ocean,⁶ and emphasizing the importance of these zones in maintaining stability and security in those regions,

Recalling further its resolutions [72/241](#) of 20 December 2017 on a world against violence and violent extremism, [75/291](#) of 30 June 2021 on the seventh review of the United Nations Global Counter-Terrorism Strategy and [70/254](#) of 12 February 2016 on the Secretary-General's Plan of Action to Prevent Violent Extremism, and recalling the establishment of the Office of Counter-Terrorism under resolution [71/291](#) of 15 June 2017,

Recalling the 2005 World Summit Outcome adopted at the high-level plenary meeting of the General Assembly,⁷

Welcoming the observance of 10 December as Human Rights Day,⁸ 9 December as the International Day of Commemoration and Dignity of the Victims of the Crime of Genocide and of the Prevention of This Crime,⁹ 2 October as the International Day of Non-Violence,¹⁰ 18 June as the International Day for Countering Hate Speech,¹¹ 16 May as the International Day of Living Together in Peace,¹² 21 August as the International Day of Remembrance of and Tribute to the Victims of Terrorism,¹³ 4 February as the International Day of Human Fraternity¹⁴ and 22 August as the International Day Commemorating the Victims of Acts of Violence Based on Religion or Belief,¹⁵ as proclaimed by the United Nations,

Recognizing that all efforts made by the United Nations system in general and the international community at large for the prevention of conflicts, the peaceful settlement of disputes, peacekeeping, peacebuilding, mediation, disarmament, sustainable development, the promotion of human dignity and human rights, social

² Resolution [55/2](#).

³ Resolution [70/1](#).

⁴ Resolution [76/299](#).

⁵ Resolution [41/11](#).

⁶ Resolution [2832 \(XXVI\)](#).

⁷ Resolution [60/1](#).

⁸ Resolution [423 \(V\)](#).

⁹ Resolution [69/323](#).

¹⁰ Resolution [61/271](#).

¹¹ Resolution [75/309](#).

¹² Resolution [72/130](#).

¹³ Resolution [72/165](#).

¹⁴ Resolution [75/200](#).

¹⁵ Resolution [73/296](#).

inclusion, democracy, the rule of law, good governance and gender equality at the national and international levels contribute greatly to a culture of peace,

Taking note of the United Nations Strategy and Plan of Action on Hate Speech, in which it is proposed that the United Nations system establish and strengthen partnerships with new and traditional media to promote the values of tolerance, non-discrimination, pluralism and freedom of opinion and expression, and to address hate speech narratives,

Recognizing that efforts towards peacebuilding and sustaining peace need to take into account the promotion of a culture of peace and vice versa,

Recalling its resolution [76/6](#) of 15 November 2021 on the report of the Secretary-General entitled “Our Common Agenda”,¹⁶ and its follow-up processes,

Recognizing that the collective well-being, safety, security and prosperity of our nations and peoples are deeply intertwined, which requires us to work urgently and together in accordance with the Charter to address global risks and challenges, find viable solutions and accelerate the implementation of agreed frameworks, including the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and the Sustainable Development Goals and the Addis Ababa Action Agenda of the Third International Conference on Financing for Development,¹⁷ as well as the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change¹⁸ and the Paris Agreement,¹⁹

Recognizing also that the open, constructive and respectful debate of ideas, as well as interreligious, interfaith and intercultural dialogue at the local, national, regional and international levels, involving civil society, can play a positive role in fostering democratic participation, ensuring equality of access to education for women, especially girls, combating hatred, incitement and violence based on religion or belief as well as racism, hate speech and other forms of intolerance, and advancing human fraternity, tolerance and solidarity,

Recognizing further the importance of respect and understanding for religious and cultural diversity throughout the world, of choosing dialogue and negotiations over confrontation and of working together and not against each other,

Taking note of the report of the Secretary-General,²⁰ which provides an overview of the actions taken across the United Nations system and by Member States to implement the Programme of Action and to promote a culture of peace and non-violence since the adoption by the General Assembly of its resolution [76/68](#),

Recalling its proclamation of the period 2022–2032 as the International Decade of Indigenous Languages,

Recalling also the proclamations by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization, in particular of 21 February as International Mother Language Day, which aims at protecting, promoting and preserving linguistic and cultural diversity and multilingualism, in order to foster and enrich a culture of peace, social harmony, cross-cultural dialogue and mutual understanding, and of 30 April as International Jazz Day, which aims to develop and increase intercultural exchanges and understanding between cultures for the purpose of mutual comprehension, tolerance and the promotion of a culture of peace,

¹⁶ [A/75/982](#).

¹⁷ Resolution [69/313](#), annex.

¹⁸ United Nations, *Treaty Series*, vol. 1771, No. 30822.

¹⁹ See [FCCC/CP/2015/10/Add.1](#), decision 1/CP.21, annex.

²⁰ [A/77/614](#).

Taking note of the Transforming Education Summit, convened by the Secretary-General from 16 to 19 September 2022 in New York, as well as its pre-Summit, hosted by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization from 28 to 30 June 2022 in Paris,

Taking note also of Member States' engagement throughout the Transforming Education Summit process, including through national consultations, and inviting the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization and relevant stakeholders, including the Sustainable Development Goal 4-Education 2030 High-level Steering Committee, to support Member States, upon their request, in the country-level implementation of their national commitments made during the Transforming Education Summit process,

Welcoming the efforts of the international community to enhance understanding through constructive dialogue among civilizations, in particular through various initiatives at the local, national, regional and international levels,

Expressing its appreciation for the ongoing efforts of the United Nations Alliance of Civilizations in promoting a culture of peace through a number of practical projects in the areas of youth, education, media and migrations, in collaboration with Governments, international organizations, foundations and civil society groups, as well as media and the private sector,

Taking note of the ninth United Nations Alliance of Civilizations Forum, held in Fez, Morocco, on 22 and 23 November 2022 on the theme "Towards an alliance of peace: living together as one humanity",

Recalling the General Assembly High-level Forum held on 13 September 2019 on the occasion of the twentieth anniversary of the adoption of the Declaration and Programme of Action and the Chair's summary of the meeting on the theme "The Culture of Peace: empowering and transforming humanity",

Welcoming the General Assembly High-level Forum on the Culture of Peace held on 6 September 2022 on the theme "The Culture of Peace: importance of justice, equality and inclusion for advancing peacebuilding", at which Member States and observers of the General Assembly and other stakeholders renewed their commitments to the full and effective implementation of the Declaration and Programme of Action with the active participation of civil society, in particular substantive support from the Global Movement for the Culture of Peace,

Taking note of the outcome document of the international conference entitled "Dialogue is a Guarantee of Peace", held in Ashgabat on 11 December 2022,²¹ and the Declaration of the Seventh Congress of the Leaders of World and Traditional Religions, held in Astana on 14 and 15 September 2022,²²

Noting with appreciation that the Declaration and Programme of Action continue to find relevance across the three pillars of the United Nations, which are interconnected and mutually reinforcing, in addressing contemporary global challenges,

Recalling the high-level plenary meeting of the General Assembly, known as the Nelson Mandela Peace Summit, convened by the President of the Assembly on 24 September 2018, and the adoption of its political declaration,²³

²¹ A/77/651, annex.

²² A/77/360, annex.

²³ Resolution 73/1.

Recognizing the urgent need to promote and strengthen preventive diplomacy, inter alia, through multilateralism, international cooperation and political dialogue, and stressing the crucial role of the United Nations in this regard,

Recognizing also the role of women and youth, as well as the contribution of children and older persons in advancing a culture of peace, and in particular the importance of ensuring gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls, with the aim of advancing the full, equal and meaningful participation of women in the prevention and resolution of conflicts and in activities promoting a culture of peace, including in post-conflict situations,

Noting the important and positive contribution of youth in efforts to counter terrorism and prevent violent extremism as and when conducive to terrorism, as well as for the promotion of peace and security, sustainable development and human rights, and the importance of the full, effective, constructive and inclusive participation of youth in decision-making, and noting in this regard the establishment of the United Nations Youth Office,

Recalling the adoption by the General Conference of the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization at its thirty-sixth session of a programme of action for a culture of peace and non-violence, and noting that the objectives of that programme of action are in line with the Declaration and Programme of Action on a Culture of Peace adopted by the General Assembly,

Recognizing the activities of the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization related to the culture of peace and non-violence and their focus on concrete actions at the global, regional and subregional levels, and noting its support for the Member States, upon their request, in promoting the culture of peace at the national level,

Noting with deep concern that the coronavirus disease (COVID-19) pandemic is one of the greatest global challenges in the history of the United Nations, which has led to a rise in hate speech, stigmatization, racism and xenophobia, exacerbated pre-existing inequalities in income, opportunities, access to information and communications technologies, health coverage and social protection, deepened gender inequality, and created new challenges with regard to access to health-care services and vaccines,

Recognizing that the digital sphere and its ongoing transformation are an important area for global action on building a culture of peace,

Noting the initiatives of civil society, in collaboration with Governments, to strengthen civilian capacities to enhance the physical safety of vulnerable populations under threat of violence and to promote the peaceful settlement of disputes,

Encouraging the continued and increasing efforts and activities on the part of civil society organizations throughout the world in advancing a culture of peace as envisaged in the Declaration and Programme of Action,

1. *Reiterates* that the objective of the effective implementation of the Programme of Action on a Culture of Peace is to strengthen further the global movement for a culture of peace, and calls upon all concerned to renew their attention to this objective;

2. *Invites* Member States to continue to place greater emphasis on and expand their activities promoting a culture of peace at the national, regional and international levels and to ensure that peace and non-violence are fostered at all levels;

3. *Invites* the entities of the United Nations system, within their existing mandates, to integrate, as appropriate, the eight action areas of the Programme of

Action into their programmes of activities, focusing on promoting a culture of peace and non-violence at the national, regional and international levels;

4. *Commends* the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization for strengthening efforts to mobilize all relevant stakeholders within and outside the United Nations system in support of a culture of peace, and invites the Organization to continue to enhance communication and outreach, including through the culture of peace website;

5. *Commends* the practical initiatives and actions by relevant United Nations bodies, including the United Nations Children's Fund, the United Nations Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women (UN-Women) and the University for Peace, as well as their activities in further promoting a culture of peace and non-violence, in particular the promotion of peace education and activities related to specific areas identified in the Programme of Action, and encourages them to continue and further strengthen and expand their efforts;

6. *Stresses* the importance of addressing the underlying drivers of violence and conflict to promote a culture of peace;

7. *Encourages* Member States, United Nations entities and other relevant actors to adopt a holistic approach to the cross-cutting dimensions of peace, development, humanitarian action and human rights in order to prevent the recurrence of conflict and build lasting peace;

8. *Underlines* that early childhood development contributes to the development of more peaceful societies through advancing equality, tolerance, human development and promoting human rights, and calls for investment in early childhood education, including through effective policies and practices, towards promoting a culture of peace;

9. *Encourages* Member States, United Nations entities, regional and subregional organizations and relevant actors to consider instituting mechanisms to involve youth in the promotion of a culture of peace, tolerance and intercultural and interreligious dialogue and develop, as appropriate, an understanding of respect for human dignity, pluralism and diversity, including, as appropriate, through education programmes, that could discourage their participation in acts of terrorism, violent extremism as and when conducive to terrorism, violence, xenophobia and all forms of discrimination;

10. *Encourages* the United Nations Alliance of Civilizations to increase its activities that focus on peace education and global citizenship education in order to enhance an understanding among young people of values such as peace, tolerance, openness, inclusion and mutual respect, which are essential in developing a culture of peace;

11. *Encourages* the United Nations peacebuilding architecture to continue to promote peacebuilding and sustaining peace activities, as outlined in its resolutions [72/276](#) and [75/201](#), and to advance a culture of peace and non-violence in post-conflict peacebuilding efforts at the country level, and recognizes the important role of the Peacebuilding Commission in this regard;

12. *Emphasizes* the critical importance of an inclusive, resilient and sustainable recovery from the COVID-19 pandemic, and in this regard calls upon States to promote the values of a culture of peace, inter alia, in countering rising inequalities, discrimination, exclusion, hate crimes and violence;

13. *Urges* the appropriate authorities to provide age-appropriate education in children's schools that builds a culture of peace and non-violence, including lessons

in mutual understanding, respect, tolerance, active and global citizenship and human rights;

14. *Encourages* the involvement of media, especially the mass media, in promoting a culture of peace and non-violence, with particular regard to children and young people;

15. *Commends* civil society, non-governmental organizations and young people for their activities in further promoting a culture of peace and non-violence, including through their campaign to raise awareness on a culture of peace and the peaceful settlement of disputes;

16. *Encourages* civil society and non-governmental organizations to further strengthen their efforts to promote a culture of peace, inter alia, by adopting their own programme of activities to complement the initiatives of Member States, the United Nations system and other international and regional organizations, in line with the Declaration and Programme of Action;

17. *Invites* Member States, all entities of the United Nations system and civil society organizations to accord increasing attention to their observance of the International Day of Peace on 21 September each year as a day of global ceasefire and non-violence, in accordance with its resolution [55/282](#) of 7 September 2001, and of the International Day of Non-Violence on 2 October, in accordance with its resolution [61/271](#) of 15 June 2007;

18. *Requests* the President of the General Assembly to consider convening a high-level forum, as appropriate and within existing resources, devoted to the implementation of the Programme of Action on the occasion of the anniversary of its adoption, on or around 13 September, and requests the Secretariat to provide required logistical support for its effective organization within their respective mandates and existing resources;

19. *Invites* the Secretary-General, within existing resources, in consultation with the Member States and taking into account the observations of civil society organizations, to explore mechanisms and strategies, in particular strategies in the sphere of information and communications technology, for the implementation of the Declaration and Programme of Action and to initiate outreach efforts to increase global awareness of the Programme of Action and its eight areas of action aimed at their implementation, including through public information activities by the Department of Global Communications of the Secretariat;

20. *Requests* the Secretary-General to submit to the General Assembly at its seventy-ninth session a report, within existing resources, on actions taken by Member States, on the basis of information provided by them, and those taken system-wide by all concerned entities of the United Nations to implement the present resolution;

21. *Decides* to include in the provisional agenda of its seventy-eighth session the item entitled “Culture of peace”.

*79th plenary meeting
14 June 2023*